

Component 2: Performance from Text

Overview

Performance texts have been at the core of drama since the inception of theatre. The need to hand down stories has been fundamental to human development and for thousands of years, people have written, performed, watched and enjoyed innumerable plays.

Understanding a performance text is fundamental to the subject, as this provides students with opportunities to explore plot, structure, narrative and stories from around the world and from different time periods. It encourages them to develop empathy skills, as they consider different characters and develop methods of communicating ideas and themes.

This component deals with developing knowledge, understanding and skills in exploring and performing from a performance text. Students will interpret this text and rehearse and refine two key extracts, leading to a final performance. They will demonstrate and use a wide range of acting and/or design skills to communicate their interpretation in performance.

Content

There are **two** areas of focus.

- 1) Interpreting and exploring **two key extracts** from a chosen performance text.
- 2) Performing or realising a design of **two key extracts** from this text.

Students may complete this component as a performer or designer or as a combination of both.

The design roles are:

- costume design
- lighting design
- set design
- sound design.

Centres wanting to offer design roles to students should refer to *Appendix 3: Design roles minimum resource requirements for centres*.

Text and extract choice

Centres can choose any performance text as long as it meets the following criteria.

- It must have been professionally commissioned or professionally produced and be at least 45 minutes in length.
- It offers students the opportunity to demonstrate exploratory range and depth.
- It offers students the opportunity to access the demands of this component as a performer and/or designer.
- It must have a degree of a challenge, in terms of appropriateness of content, themes and contexts to enable students to achieve at GCSE and access the Assessment Objective.
- It must provide a contrast to the text studied for Component 3 (see *pages 6–8*) and cannot be any prescribed text from the Component 3 lists.

Centres are reminded that they must complete a form regarding the text choices, please refer to *page 6* for details.

Key extracts

Students must study **two key extracts** from their chosen performance text.

For the purposes of this qualification, a **key extract** is defined as a scene or a moment that is significant to the text as a whole and at least 10 minutes in length when performed.

Students may participate in the two key extracts as a performer or designer or as a combination of both.

For each extract students may perform/design in a monologue, duologue or group – the choice is open to centres. The approaches that could be followed are, for example:

Student A	Example approach
Extract 1	Performs a monologue
Extract 2	Performs in group

Student B	Example approach
Extract 1	Performs in group
Extract 2	Performs in group

Student C	Example approach
Extract 1	Designs for a monologue
Extract 2	Performs in a duologue

Students are not required to perform the same character or role in both key extracts.

Whole cohorts do not need to use the same performance texts.

Selecting a key extract

This can take the form of a continuous dialogue/scene, or edited extracts, for example abridging the extract to match the number of performers taking part.

For the monologue/duologue, the extract chosen may be edited to provide the required amount of material, but must provide a coherent monologue or duologue.

NB: Text can be edited through removal of characters/content/lines, as long as the meaning and shape/sequence of the text is maintained. Dialogue cannot be added or altered in the text.

Each selected extract will be assessed independently and it should be clear where each extract begins and ends.

Students are required to perform/realise a design for all or part of these key extracts, following the extract timings requirements below.

Centres must choose **one** of the approaches listed below when selecting the two key extracts.

Approach	Example
1. Select two separate key moments/scenes from the same text.	<i>Too Much Punch For Judy</i> , Mark Wheeler Extract 1: The crash and immediate aftermath. Extract 2: PC Caton informs Vi of the crash.
2. Select two consecutive key moments/scenes from the same text.	<i>Blood Brothers</i> , Willy Russell Extract 1: Mrs Lyon's breakdown and demand to move away to the countryside. Extract 2: Mickey and Eddie say their goodbyes; Mrs Johnstone says a private goodbye to Eddie.

Requirements per key extract

Each student needs to participate in two key extracts as a performer/designer. The timings given below are for one key extract performance/design realisation.

Monologue and duologue

The regulatory requirements for monologue and duologue performances are that they must complete a minimum monologue performance time of 2 minutes and a minimum duologue performance time of 3 minutes per key extract.

Number of performers	Minimum performance time per key extract	Maximum performance time per key extract
1 performance student (monologue)	2 minutes	3 minutes
2 performance students (duologue)	3 minutes	5 minutes

Group performance

A group must be between **three** and **six** performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per group.

The regulatory requirements for groups are that they must complete a minimum performance time of 4 minutes per key extract.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the group has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group size	Recommended minimum performance time per key extract	Maximum performance time per key extract
3–4 performance students (group)	10 minutes	12 minutes
5–6 performance students (group)	13 minutes	15 minutes

Centres should be aware that performance times that are between the regulatory minimum (4 minutes) and the recommended minimum (10 or 13 minutes) may not allow students to evidence their skills fully in order to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

All students will be assessed as individuals.

Meeting the performance timings

For students (performance and design) who do not meet the regulatory minimum performance requirement of 2, 3 and/or 4 minutes, the examiner will use their professional judgement against the AO2 assessment criteria based on what the student has achieved and then the total mark will be reduced proportionally according to how many seconds the work is under length.

The proportional time penalty will be applied by Pearson Edexcel after the work has been marked by the examiner, using the conversion tables in *Appendix 6*.

Examiners will be required to stop marking after the maximum performance time has passed.

Requirements for performances/design realisations

All performances/design realisations should take place in front of an appropriate audience and must be recorded. Centres are free to identify their own suitable audience and venue for the performance, this could include:

- performance to the rest of the class or another class within the centre
- performance to an invited external audience.

Teachers should adopt a facilitating role and may direct. They may direct and give guidance during the practical work and the preparation for performance(s) but not during the performance(s).

When directing, teachers are allowed to:

- interpret and structure the text as written to meet the demands of the examination (time limits etc.)
- suggest solutions to artistic and creative problems referring to the assessment criteria if appropriate
- make artistic and creative decisions referring to the assessment criteria if appropriate (however, they should not make direct judgements about the assessment criteria or allocate marks).

Performance roles

Performers must gain knowledge and understanding to explore how meaning is communicated through:

- themes, issues, performance conventions
- genre, structure, form, style, language and stage directions
- character relationships
- character development.

Performers must develop skills in:

- how meaning is communicated and interpreted through:
 - the use of voice, physical and non-verbal techniques (such as facial expression and gesture)
 - use of space and spatial relationships
 - the presentation of characters/roles
 - relationships between performer and audience
 - production elements, such as set (including props), costume, lighting and sound.

Also:

- characterisation
- voice: use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection
- physicality: use of space, gesture, facial expression, stillness and stance
- communicating creative intent to audience
- communication with other performers and/or with the audience.

Performers must understand how performance is created from a text. They should demonstrate the skills through:

- developing interpretations independently and collaboratively
- the development of specific artistic intentions
- learning lines, rehearsing, amending and refining text extracts in progress for performance
- performing to an audience.

Students should take into consideration any health and safety implications as appropriate.

Design roles

Designers must work collaboratively within a group of performers within their chosen area of design.

Where a student is assessed in a design role, it is their design skill that is the focus of the assessment, rather than their technical competence in the operation or use of equipment. The performance(s) must provide sufficient opportunity for design students to meet the demands of this component.

There is a maximum of one designer per role, per group.

Designers must gain knowledge and understanding to explore how meaning is communicated through:

- genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- performance conventions
- use of space and spatial relationships
- relationship between performer and audience
- production elements.

Designers must understand how text-based performance is created. They should demonstrate the skills through:

- developing interpretations independently and collaboratively
- the development of specific artistic intentions
- rehearsing, amending and refining text extracts in progress for performance.

Designers must also develop skills in:

- making appropriate judgements during the development process
- interpreting content, narrative, style and form
- responding and adapting designs in response to rehearsal work (to be done collaboratively with the teacher-director)
- using and applying design skills to contribute to the performance as a whole
- demonstrating the ability to apply design skills effectively within the context of the performance
- communicating intention to an audience.

Designs should take into consideration performer/audience relationships and any health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.

A list of the requirements for each design skill for this component is given on the next page.

Component 2 - Requirements for design skills				
Requirements	Costume design	Lighting design	Set design	Sound design
Requirements per extract	Group: final costume designs for one character, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations if appropriate. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate. All sourcing must be based wholly on the student's design(s).	Group: final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of at least two different lighting states. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.	Group: drawings of the final design to be realised in the performance space including any relevant props. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.	Group: source sheet showing at least two sound cues –original, live or found sound effects as appropriate. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.
	Mono or duo: final costume design for one character, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations if appropriate. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.	Mono or duo: final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of at least two different lighting states. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.	Mono or duo: drawings of the final designs to be realised in the performance space. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.	Mono or duo: source sheet showing the at least two sound cues –original, live or found sound effects as appropriate. This should take into consideration performer/ audience relationships, health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.
Additional documentation	For both performances: a costume plot or list of costumes/accessories worn by each performer indicating any changes as appropriate.	For both performances: a lighting plot or cue sheet showing at least four different lighting states as appropriate.	For both performances: a ground plan of the performance space, including entrances and exits, audience positioning and stage furniture (as appropriate).	For both performances: a cue sheet showing the source, order, length and output level of each cue.

Component 2 - Requirements for design skills <i>continued</i>				
Requirements	Costume design	Lighting design	Set design	Sound design
Supervision	The student must supervise the construction and/or sourcing of the designed costumes as appropriate.	The student must supervise the rigging, focusing, programming (if applicable) and operating of the design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the construction, painting, hiring and/or finding of scenic elements required to meet the requirements of their design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the production of the final sound design which they have created and recorded using live and/or sampled material as appropriate.
Performance	A realisation of the costume design in both performances.	A realisation of the lighting design in both performances.	A realisation of the set design in both performances.	A realisation of the sound design in both performances.

NB: Centres are reminded that any appropriate evidence produced in line with the requirements above should also be made available to the visiting examiner when they make their visit.

Assessment information

This component is externally assessed by a visiting examiner or by an examiner assessing the recorded live performance. It is worth 48 marks and AO2 is assessed.

First assessment: 2018

The performance(s) **must** be recorded by the centre and unedited. Please refer to *Appendix 4: Best practice when recording performance*. This recorded evidence is to be sent to the examiner.

Centres must select **two key extracts** and each extract is worth 24 marks each. Each selected extract will be assessed independently and it should be clear where each extract begins and ends.

Teachers can give support and guidance at the development stage but not during the performance(s).

All centres must provide their examiner, before the visit/date of recording, with the following information:

- a declaration that all key extracts studied by students meet the requirements to be from a scene or a moment that is significant to the text as a whole and at least 10 minutes in length when performed.
- indication of group numbers and performance lengths
- character/design role information for each student to be assessed
- the performance text(s) chosen for Component 3 (in order for the contrasting text requirement to be checked)
- a brief written explanation by each student of the intention for each performance or design.

For guidance, the explanation must include the following:

for performance students (100–200 words per character played)

- what role(s) are you playing?
- what is happening to your character(s) in the key extract?
- what are your character's objectives/motivations/feelings?
- how are you interpreting this character(s) in performance? (i.e. vocal, physical, communication of intent).

For design students (100–200 words per extract designed for)

- what design role are you fulfilling?
- what is your central design concept in the key extract?
- how have you interpreted this key extract through your design?
- what are you hoping to communicate to the audience?

Non-assessed individuals

Non-assessed individuals should be used **only** when:

- the total number of students in the cohort does not meet the minimum group size requirement
- a student has withdrawn from the performance near to the assessment date
- a student is absent on the day of the assessment.

Non-assessed individuals may be used to read out the lines of the absent student(s) to support the performance group. Please note that a non-assessed individual may be a class peer, student from a different year group or a member of staff. Assessed and non-assessed individuals must be clearly identified at the start of the recorded evidence to aid assessment.

Permission must be sought from Pearson in advance for the inclusion of non-assessed individuals. Please email your requests to drama.assessment@pearson.com. Please upload to Learner Work Transfer when submitting assessment materials.

Assessment criteria

Visiting examiners will use the following assessment criteria to mark students' work. Each mark grid identifies which Assessment Objective is being targeted.

The visiting examiner will mark each extract out of 24, using the following criteria and add these marks together to give a total out of 48.

Assessment criteria for performers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers) Vocal and physical skills
	0	No rewardable material or performances below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	• Vocal skills are underdeveloped, demonstrating limited understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Vocal delivery is often inappropriate and inconsistent. • Basic technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). Vocal performance lacks variation and range. • Physical skills are underdeveloped, demonstrating limited understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Physical delivery is often inappropriate and inconsistent. • Basic technical control in the use of physical techniques (gesture, facial expression, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Physical performance lacks variation and range.
Level 2	3–4	• Vocal skills are sound, demonstrating an adequate understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Vocal delivery is generally appropriate and consistent. • Sound technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). Vocal performance shows general variation and range. • Physical skills are sound, demonstrating an adequate understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Physical delivery is generally appropriate and consistent. • Sound technical control in the use of physical techniques (gesture, facial expression, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Physical performance shows general variation and range.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers) Vocal and physical skills
Level 3	5–6	• Vocal skills are secure, demonstrating an effective understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Vocal delivery is appropriate and consistent throughout. • Secure technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). Vocal performance shows competent variation and range. • Physical skills are secure, demonstrating an effective understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Physical delivery is appropriate and consistent throughout. • Secure technical control in the use of physical techniques (gesture, facial expression, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Physical performance shows competent variation and range.
Level 4	7–8	• Vocal skills are assured, demonstrating a comprehensive understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Vocal delivery is engaging and dynamic throughout. • Accomplished technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). Vocal performance shows comprehensive variation and range. • Physical skills are assured, demonstrating a comprehensive understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. Physical delivery is engaging and dynamic throughout. • Accomplished technical control in the use of physical techniques (gesture, facial expression, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Physical performance shows comprehensive variation and range.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers) Characterisation and communication
	0	No rewardable material or performances below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	• Characterisation demonstrates basic understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Characterisation is uneven and lacks clarity, with obvious lapses in focus and confidence. • Limited rapport and communication with audience/other performers.
Level 2	3–4	• Characterisation demonstrates a sound understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Characterisation is generally consistent and sound, demonstrating adequate focus and confidence. • Sound rapport and communication with audience/other performers.
Level 3	5–6	• Characterisation demonstrates a secure understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Characterisation is consistent and secure, demonstrating effective focus and confidence. • Effective rapport and communication with audience/other performers.
Level 4	7–8	• Characterisation demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of the role and its context within the performance. • Characterisation is accomplished, skilful and highly engaging, demonstrating comprehensive and assured focus, confidence and commitment. • Assured rapport and communication with audience/other performers.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (performers) Artistic intention and style/genre/theatrical conventions
	0	No rewardable material or performances below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	• Basic contribution to the realisation of the artistic intention in performance. • Performance demonstrates limited control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Demonstrates a basic interpretation of the text in performance. • Individual performance is undeveloped and has limited impact, lacking energy and ease.
Level 2	3–4	• Clear contribution to the realisation of the artistic intention in performance. • Performance demonstrates clear control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Demonstrates a coherent interpretation of the text in performance. • Individual performance is generally developed and has clear impact, showing emerging energy and ease.
Level 3	5–6	• Effective contribution to the realisation of the artistic intention in performance. • Performance demonstrates secure control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Demonstrates a convincing and sustained interpretation of the text in performance. • Individual performance is developed, thoughtful and sympathetic, creating effective impact and showing sustained energy and ease.
Level 4	7–8	• Assured contribution to the realisation of the artistic intention in performance. • Performance demonstrates assured and sustained control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Demonstrates an accomplished and comprehensive interpretation of the text in performance. • Individual performance is refined, articulate and dynamic, creating significant impact with ability to drive the piece, showing accomplished energy and ease.

Assessment criteria for designers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (designers)
		Design skills
	0	No rewardable material or designs below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	- Creates an underdeveloped and often inappropriate and inconsistent design, demonstrating limited understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Basic use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Basic ability to combine and apply design skills to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Design shows limited understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.
Level 2	3–4	- Creates a sound and generally appropriate and consistent design, demonstrating adequate understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Sound use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Sound ability to combine and apply design skills to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Design shows adequate understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.
Level 3	5–6	- Creates a secure, appropriate and consistent design, demonstrating effective understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Secure use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Secure ability to combine and apply design skills to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Design shows effective understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.
Level 4	7–8	- Creates an assured, engaging and dynamic design, demonstrating comprehensive understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Accomplished use of visual/audio elements to enhance mood, atmosphere and style and create impact. - Assured ability to combine and apply design skills to design creatively within time and resource constraints. - Design shows comprehensive understanding of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (designers) Communication and contribution to performance as whole
	0	No rewardable material or designs below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	• Design shows a basic understanding of its context and purpose within the performance. • Design concept is uneven and lacks clarity, demonstrating inappropriate connections and choices made in relation to content of performance. • Design lacks cohesion with content of performance, demonstrating limited communication and collaboration with performers.
Level 2	3–4	• Design shows a sound understanding of its context and purpose within the performance. • Design concept is generally consistent, demonstrating sound connections and choices made in relation to content of performance. • Design has adequate cohesion with content of performance, demonstrating sound communication and collaboration with performers.
Level 3	5–6	• Design shows a secure understanding of its context and purpose within the performance. • Design concept is consistent and secure demonstrating effective connections and choices made in relation to content of performance. • Design has sustained cohesion with content of performance, demonstrating effective communication and collaboration with performers.
Level 4	7–8	• Design shows a comprehensive understanding of its context and purpose within the performance. • Design concept is accomplished, skilful and highly engaging, demonstrating comprehensive connections and assured choices made in relation to content of performance. • Design has comprehensive cohesion with content of performance, demonstrating assured communication and collaboration with performers.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2) Apply theatrical skills to realise artistic intentions in live performance (designers) Artistic intentions and style/genre/theatrical conventions
	0	No rewardable material or designs below the regulatory minimum time
Level 1	1–2	• Design makes a basic contribution to the realisation of artistic intentions. • Design demonstrates limited control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Design demonstrates basic interpretation of the text, inconsistently supporting the performance of the extract. • Design is underdeveloped with obvious lapses in design considerations that detract from the overall production value.
Level 2	3–4	• Design makes a clear contribution to the realisation of artistic intentions. • Design shows clear control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Design demonstrates coherent interpretation of the text, and is generally consistent in supporting the performance of the extract. • Design is generally developed with coherent design considerations that have clear impact on the overall production value.
Level 3	5–6	• Design makes an effective contribution to the realisation of artistic intentions. • Design shows secure control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Design demonstrates convincing and sustained interpretation of the text, consistently supporting the performance of the extract. • Design is developed and thoughtful with secure design considerations that have an effective impact on the overall production value.
Level 4	7–8	• Design makes an assured and sustained contribution to the realisation of artistic intentions. • Design shows assured control and understanding in relation to style, genre and theatrical conventions. • Design demonstrates an accomplished and comprehensive interpretation of the text, showing sustained and assured support for the performance of the extract. • Design is refined and dynamic with design considerations that have a significant impact and enhance the overall production value.